SUPERSTORE SALES PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS FINAL REPORT BY NWACHUKWU CHINECHELUM EUCHARIA

Project Overview

This project analyses Superstore sales data from January 2015 to December 2018 using SQL and Microsoft Power BI. The objective was to evaluate sales performance, identify trends, understand customer and product contributions, and examine regional sales patterns.

The dataset contains 9,800 records covering sales transactions across different products, customer segments, and regions. Power Query was used for data preparation, while DAX was used to create key performance measures and support the analysis.

Key Insights and Recommendations

Insight 1: Overall Sales Performance

The Superstore generated approximately **$2.26 million in total sales** from 4,922 unique orders and 793 customers. The average order value was approximately $459.48.

Recommendation: The business should monitor average order value and explore opportunities to increase the value of customer purchases through product bundles, complementary product suggestions, and targeted promotions.

Insight 2: Annual Sales Trends

Sales declined by approximately **4.3% in 2016**, compared with 2015. However, the business recovered in 2017, recording approximately 30.6% growth, followed by another 20.3% increase in 2018. The highest annual sales were recorded in 2018, at approximately $722,052.

Recommendation: Management should investigate the factors behind the 2016 decline and identify the strategies or business conditions that contributed to the subsequent recovery. Successful approaches should be evaluated for continued use.

Insight 3: Product Category Performance

Technology generated the highest sales, contributing approximately **$827,456 (36.6%)** of total sales. Furniture followed with $728,659 (32.2%), while Office Supplies contributed $705,422 (31.2%).

Recommendation: The business should continue monitoring demand across all three categories and assess opportunities to expand sales in strong-performing categories. Further analysis of costs and profit margins is needed before making decisions about product profitability.

Insight 4: Regional Sales Performance

The West region recorded the highest sales at approximately **$710,220 (31.5%)**, followed by the East at $669,519 (29.7%). The Central region contributed $492,647 (21.8%), while the South recorded the lowest sales at $389,151 (17.2%).

Recommendation: Management should examine customer demand, product preferences, and sales distribution in the South and Central regions to identify opportunities for improvement. The business should also investigate what contributes to the West region's stronger sales performance.

Insight 5: Customer Segment Contribution

The Consumer segment accounted for approximately **50.9% of total sales**, making it the largest customer segment. Corporate contributed 30.5%, while Home Office accounted for 18.6%.

Recommendation: The business should maintain its focus on the Consumer segment while developing targeted marketing and engagement strategies for Corporate and Home Office customers to improve their contribution to overall sales.

Insight 6: Top-Performing Product Sub-Categories

Phones and Chairs were the leading product sub-categories, generating approximately $328,000 and $323,000 in sales, respectively. This indicates that these product groups make significant contributions to overall revenue.

Recommendation: The business should monitor demand for these products and assess opportunities to improve their availability and visibility. It should also investigate the performance of lower-selling sub-categories to identify products that may require better marketing or a review of their market positioning.

Insight 7: Shipping Mode Usage

Standard Class was the most frequently used shipping method, accounting for approximately 2,945 orders, followed by Second Class with 944 orders, First Class with 772 orders, and Same Day with 261 orders. This indicates a strong preference for Standard Class shipping among customers.

Recommendation: The business should continue monitoring the demand for Standard Class shipping while evaluating whether the other shipping options meet customer expectations. It could also review the cost and operational implications of each shipping method before making changes to its shipping strategy.

Insight 8: Sales Concentration Across Cities

New York City recorded the highest sales among the displayed top 10 cities, contributing approximately $250,000, followed by Los Angeles at $170,000 and Seattle at $120,000. This suggests that a relatively small group of cities contributes substantially to sales.

Recommendation: The business should maintain strong customer engagement in high-performing cities while investigating opportunities to increase sales in cities with lower contributions. Regional and city-level marketing strategies could help identify and address differences in customer demand.

Conclusion

The analysis shows that the Superstore recorded positive overall sales performance over the four-year period, despite a decline in 2016. Technology was the leading product category, the West was the strongest region, and the Consumer segment contributed the largest share of sales.

The findings provide management with a clearer understanding of sales trends, product performance, customer contributions, and regional differences. Implementing the recommendations and conducting further analysis could help the business identify growth opportunities and make better-informed decisions.

Data Limitations

The dataset contains sales information but does not include profit, product quantity, discount, cost, returns, inventory, or actual delivery-date information. Therefore, the analysis focuses on sales performance and order-to-ship patterns rather than profitability, units sold, inventory performance, or actual delivery performance.





